

Concision & Transitions

Study Guide - Language & Editing

1. Learning goal

Express the same meaning with direct wording and choose transitions that show the exact relationship between ideas.

2. What this skill means

Good editing removes words that repeat an idea or hide the main verb. It also uses transitions as logic signals, not decoration. A concise sentence is not merely short; it preserves every important condition, degree of certainty, and relationship.

3. Do not confuse it with

"The committee made a decision to delay" can become "The committee decided to delay." But deleting "for six weeks" would change useful information. Likewise, however, therefore, for example, and meanwhile are not interchangeable.

4. How GED-style questions may ask it

Questions may ask for the most concise revision without changing meaning or the transition that best expresses contrast, cause-result, example, sequence, or addition.

5. Repeatable method

- State the sentence's essential meaning.
- Replace noun-heavy phrases with direct verbs when possible.
- Delete repeated words, not necessary limits or conditions.
- Name the relationship between sentences before choosing a transition.
- Reread to confirm the revision did not make the claim broader or more certain.

6. Worked example

The team conducted an evaluation of the new form. The team evaluated the new form.

Question: Why is the second sentence stronger?

Reasoning: Evaluated expresses the same action directly. The longer phrase adds no useful meaning.

Best answer: The second sentence is more concise without losing information.

7. Common traps

- Choosing the shortest option even when it deletes an important condition.
- Using therefore when the first sentence does not actually cause the second.
- Keeping phrases such as in order to, due to the fact that, or made a decision to when simpler wording works.

8. Diagnostic help

- If your revision changes a number, condition, or uncertainty word, you cut too much.
- If two transitions seem possible, state the relationship in plain language before selecting one.
- If a sentence feels heavy, find the main noun and ask whether it can become the main verb.

Why this matters in ER: Concision gives you more room for analysis in a timed ER, while precise transitions make your reasoning easier to follow.

9. Quick check

The trial reduced delays. However, staffing costs increased.

Why is however appropriate?

Check yourself: It signals a contrast between an operational benefit and a cost drawback.